

CATHARSIS 14-DAY WORKSHOP

The Boundaries Reset

A two-week workshop for protecting your energy without overexplaining, apologizing for your needs, or disappearing from connection.

14 days of teaching, reflection, scripts, tiny practices, and on-screen reset pages. About 5 minutes a day.

START HERE

Boundaries are not a wall. They are a way back to honest connection.

Many people do not avoid boundaries because they lack strength. They avoid them because their body learned that being clear might cost love, safety, approval, or belonging.

This workshop helps you identify where you overgive, practice clear language, tolerate the guilt wave, and build boundaries that are specific enough to use in real life.

You can be kind and still be clear. You can care about someone and still stop abandoning yourself.

A boundary is not a punishment. It is information about what allows you to stay present without self-betrayal.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Use this as education, not therapy

This guide is for reflection, emotional education, and self-support. It is not therapy, diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for professional care.

If your distress feels unmanageable, you feel unsafe, or daily life is becoming hard to function through, speak with a qualified mental health professional or local crisis support.

For digital use, open the PDF in Apple Preview, Adobe Reader, Chrome, Edge, or the Google Drive PDF viewer and type directly into the writable boxes. Google Docs may flatten PDF forms, so use the Drive preview/editor instead of converting the file to a Doc.

If you print it, choose black-and-white or grayscale settings to save ink. Aim for about 5 minutes a day; short, honest answers are better than perfect answers.

THE MAP

What the 14 days are really training

The reset moves from recognizing self-abandonment into clear limits, guilt tolerance, repair, and consistency.

PHASE 1

Notice the leak

Find where your time, attention, body, money, or emotional labor is being spent past capacity.

PHASE 2

Name the limit

Turn resentment into a concrete request, boundary, or personal rule.

PHASE 3

Hold the guilt wave

Learn to let discomfort pass without using overexplaining to escape it.

PHASE 4

Practice consistency

A boundary becomes real through repetition, not one perfect announcement.

SCRIPTS

Boundary scripts you can actually say

SOFT NO

I cannot take that on right now, but I hope you find the support you need.

DELAY

I need to check my capacity before I answer. I will get back to you tomorrow.

EMOTIONAL ACCESS

I care about you, and I do not have the bandwidth for this conversation tonight.

REPEATED PRESSURE

I have answered this already. I am not going to keep debating it.

REPAIR PLUS LIMIT

I am sorry my tone was sharp. The limit itself is still true for me.

FIRM FOLLOW-THROUGH

If this keeps happening, I am going to step away from the conversation.

BEFORE YOU START

Mark your starting point

This is not a scorecard. It is a snapshot you can return to after the final day.

Right now, my boundaries reset intensity is: 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

The pattern I most want to shift is:

If this workshop helps, I hope I will notice:

Find where you keep leaving yourself

The first sign you need a boundary is often resentment, dread, shutdown, irritation, or a private wish that someone would just know.

List the places where you say yes while your body says no.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Find where you keep leaving yourself

TODAY'S RESET

List the places where you say yes while your body says no.

Today's reset pairs with the Self-Abandonment deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

I most often overgive in:

My body signals no by:

The cost of ignoring that signal is:

Translate resentment into information

Resentment is not always proof someone is wrong. Sometimes it is proof a limit has not been named.

Pick one resentment and translate it into a need or limit.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Translate resentment into information

TODAY'S RESET

Pick one resentment and translate it into a need or limit.

Today's reset pairs with the Resentment deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

I feel resentful when:

The need underneath is:

The limit this points to is:

Define the boundary type

Not every boundary is a conversation. Some boundaries are requests, some are personal rules, some are consequences, and some are quiet changes in access.

Identify whether your situation needs a request, limit, consequence, or internal rule.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Define the boundary type

TODAY'S RESET

Identify whether your situation needs a request, limit, consequence, or internal rule.

Today's reset pairs with the Boundary Types deck in the Catharsis Cards app.
Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The situation is:

The boundary type needed is:

The simplest version sounds like:

Make it specific enough to keep

Vague boundaries create vague follow-through. Specific boundaries tell your future self exactly what to do when pressure rises.

Rewrite one boundary with a clear behavior, time, or condition.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Make it specific enough to keep

TODAY'S RESET

Rewrite one boundary with a clear behavior, time, or condition.

Today's reset pairs with the Clarity deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The vague boundary is:

The specific version is:

I will know I kept it when:

Stop making your boundary a court case

Overexplaining often comes from wanting the other person to approve of your limit before you feel allowed to have it.

Write a boundary in one or two sentences. Then stop.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Stop making your boundary a court case

TODAY'S RESET

Write a boundary in one or two sentences. Then stop.

Today's reset pairs with the Overexplaining deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The long explanation I want to give is:

The two-sentence version is:

What I am afraid will happen if I stop there:

Prepare for the guilt wave

Guilt after a boundary does not automatically mean the boundary was wrong. It may mean your nervous system is practicing a new kind of safety.

Plan what you will do for the first hour after setting a boundary.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Prepare for the guilt wave

TODAY'S RESET

Plan what you will do for the first hour after setting a boundary.

Today's reset pairs with the Guilt Wave deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The guilt wave usually says:

My body needs after the conversation:

My first-hour plan is:

Practice a small no

A small no trains the muscle without overwhelming the system. You do not need to start with the hardest relationship.

Say no, not now, or I cannot commit to one low-stakes request.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Practice a small no

TODAY'S RESET

Say no, not now, or I cannot commit to one low-stakes request.

Today's reset pairs with the Small No deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The small no was:

What I felt in my body:

What happened after:

Use delay as a boundary

Immediate responses can become accidental consent. Delay gives your honest no time to arrive.

Use a pause phrase before answering any request today.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Use delay as a boundary

TODAY'S RESET

Use a pause phrase before answering any request today.

Today's reset pairs with the Pause Phrase deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The request was:

My pause phrase was:

What became clearer after waiting:

Clarify access to your energy

Some people have unlimited access to your emotional labor because you never created hours, topics, or conditions for support.

Choose one access boundary for calls, texts, venting, favors, or availability.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Clarify access to your energy

TODAY'S RESET

Choose one access boundary for calls, texts, venting, favors, or availability.

Today's reset pairs with the Energy Access deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The access pattern is:

The new access boundary is:

A kind way to say it is:

Let disappointment be survivable

You can be compassionate toward someone's disappointment without making it your job to erase it.

Imagine someone being disappointed and practice not rescuing the feeling.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Let disappointment be survivable

TODAY'S RESET

Imagine someone being disappointed and practice not rescuing the feeling.

Today's reset pairs with the Disappointment deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The disappointment I fear is:

What is mine to own:

What is not mine to fix:

Repair without surrendering the limit

If your tone was off or timing was messy, you can repair the delivery without deleting the boundary.

Write a repair that keeps the limit intact.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Repair without surrendering the limit

TODAY'S RESET

Write a repair that keeps the limit intact.

Today's reset pairs with the Repair deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

What I want to repair is:

The boundary I am still keeping is:

The repair script is:

Build a consequence you can actually hold

A consequence is not a threat. It is what you will do to protect the boundary if the pattern continues.

Choose one realistic follow-through action.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Build a consequence you can actually hold

TODAY'S RESET

Choose one realistic follow-through action.

Today's reset pairs with the Follow-Through deck in the Catharsis Cards app. Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

If the pattern continues:

I will:

This protects me by:

Make peace with being less convenient

Some relationships were built around your availability. Changing that may feel disruptive even when it is healthy.

Name one way you are allowed to become less convenient.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Make peace with being less convenient

TODAY'S RESET

Name one way you are allowed to become less convenient.

Today's reset pairs with the Less Convenient deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

I have been convenient by:

I am allowed to change this by:

The relationship may need to adjust by:

Create your boundary menu

You will need different boundaries for different levels of pressure. A menu helps you respond without freezing.

Write three ready-to-use boundaries: soft, clear, and firm.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Create your boundary menu

TODAY'S RESET

Write three ready-to-use boundaries: soft, clear, and firm.

Today's reset pairs with the Boundary Menu deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

Soft boundary:

Clear boundary:

Firm boundary:

WHERE YOU ARE NOW

Compare the shift

Use the same questions from day zero so the change is visible, even if the shift is small.

Today, my boundaries reset intensity is: 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Compared with day zero, I can see:

The reset I want to keep using is:

Daily workshop tracker

Tap or annotate one short note per day. Keep it short enough to complete even on a messy day.

Day	Body cue	Old pattern	Reset used	What I learned
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				

You do not need to disappear to protect yourself.

The boundary reset is about becoming more honest, not colder. When your limits are clearer, your yes becomes cleaner, your care becomes less resentful, and your relationships get better information about the real you.

**My needs do not become too much just
because someone preferred my silence.**

RESOURCES

Continue with Catharsis

Keep going with the app, or visit Catharsis for more reflection tools.

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**One prompt. One honest answer. One small act
of self-trust.**